Whitepaper

Global eCommerce Outlook 2026

This Whitepaper shows how the global eCommerce market is stabilizing in 2026. It highlights growth in India, Indonesia, and Mexico, contrasts Europe's challenges, and explains why Grocery is outperforming while Electronics and Hobby lose ground. You'll also see how established giants struggle and disruptors like Douyin, Shein, and Temu face their first limits.

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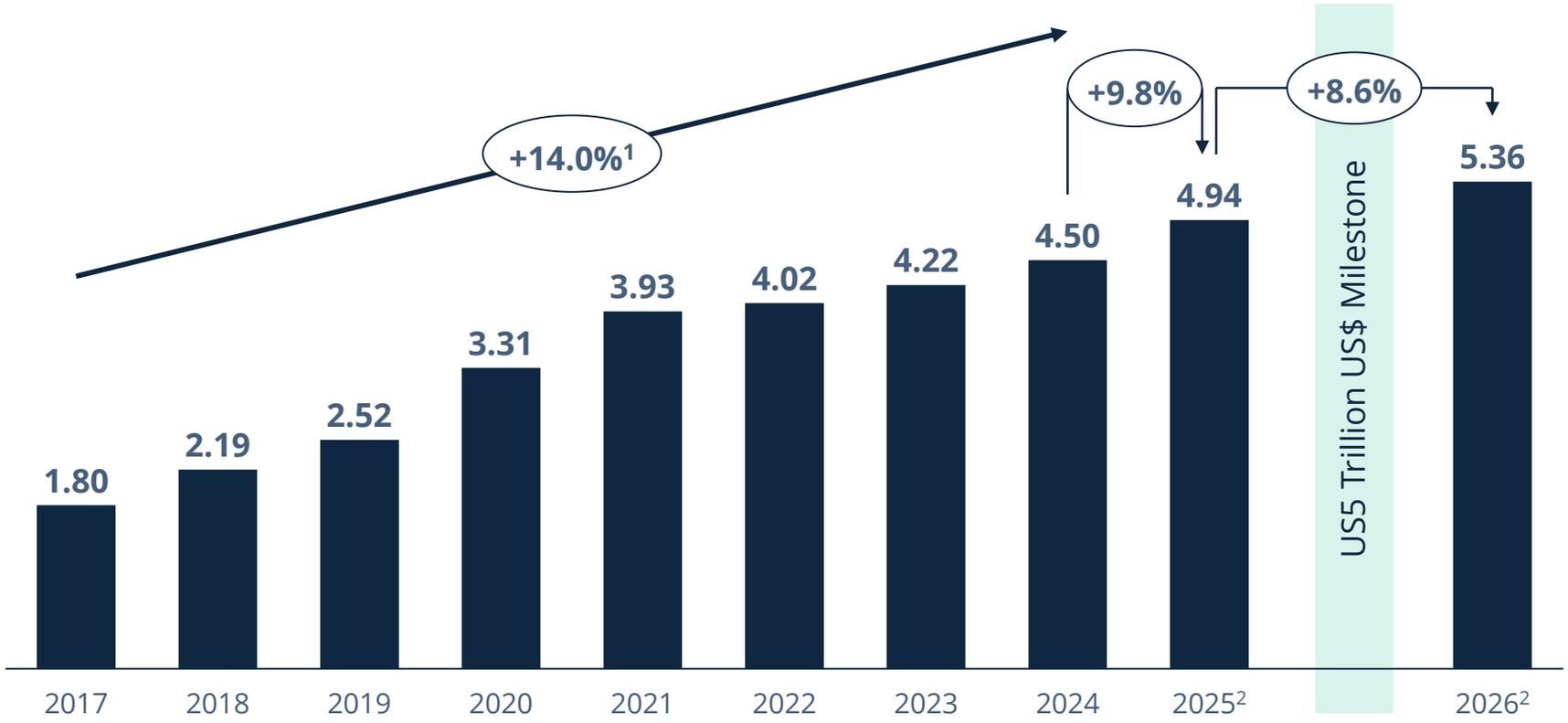
Stabilization After Pandemic Highs and Lows as eCommerce Crosses US$5 Trillion for the First Time

eCommerce Revenue Development in the Global eCommerce Market, in Trillion US$



Global eCommerce experienced strong yet volatile growth during the pandemic years, with revenues rising at a CAGR of 14% between 2017 and 2024.

While this period was marked by ups and downs, the market is now entering a more stable phase. Growth is moderating to a steadier pace, reaching **+9.8% in 2025** and **+8.6% in 2026**.

This stabilization culminates in a historic milestone: **for the first time, global eCommerce revenues surpass the US$5 trillion mark in 2026**.

Notes: (1) Compound annual growth rate (2) Forecast

Source: ECDB, as of October 2025

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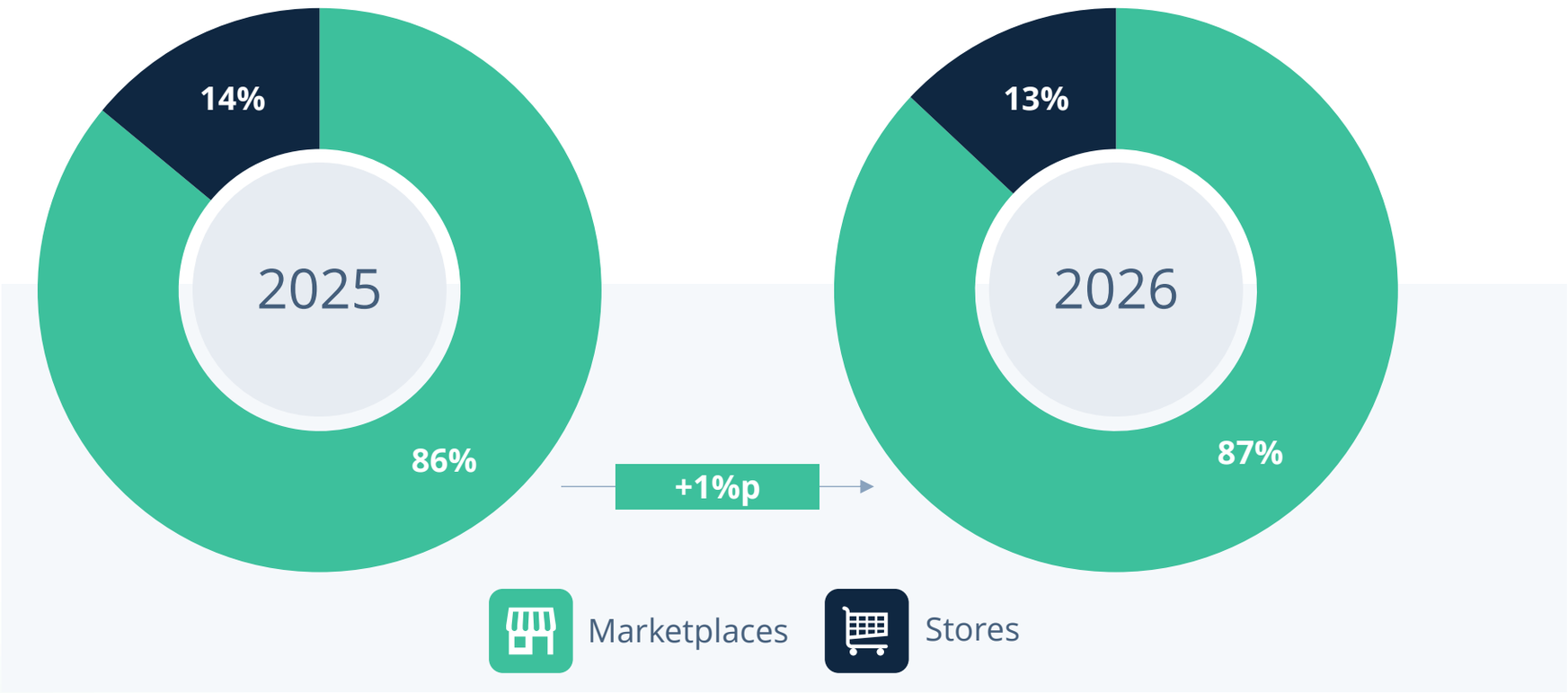
Growing Concentration: Marketplaces Account for Nearly 9 Out of 10 eCommerce Dollars in 2026

B2C Physical eCommerce Revenue Share Shops Versus Marketplaces in 2026



The concentration in eCommerce is steadily moving toward marketplaces.

In 2026, they are projected to **generate 87% of global revenues**, up one percentage point from 2025.

This continuous increase highlights the growing dominance of large marketplace ecosystems, which capture **nearly nine out of ten eCommerce dollars worldwide.**

Independent online stores, in contrast, are gradually losing relative importance as consumers and retailers alike turn to platforms such as Amazon, Alibaba, and Shopee.

Notes: The marketplace shares includes all revenues on marketplaces – both first-party sales (e.g., Amazon directly) and third-party sales (sellers on Amazon, Alibaba, etc.).

Source: ECDB, as of October 2025

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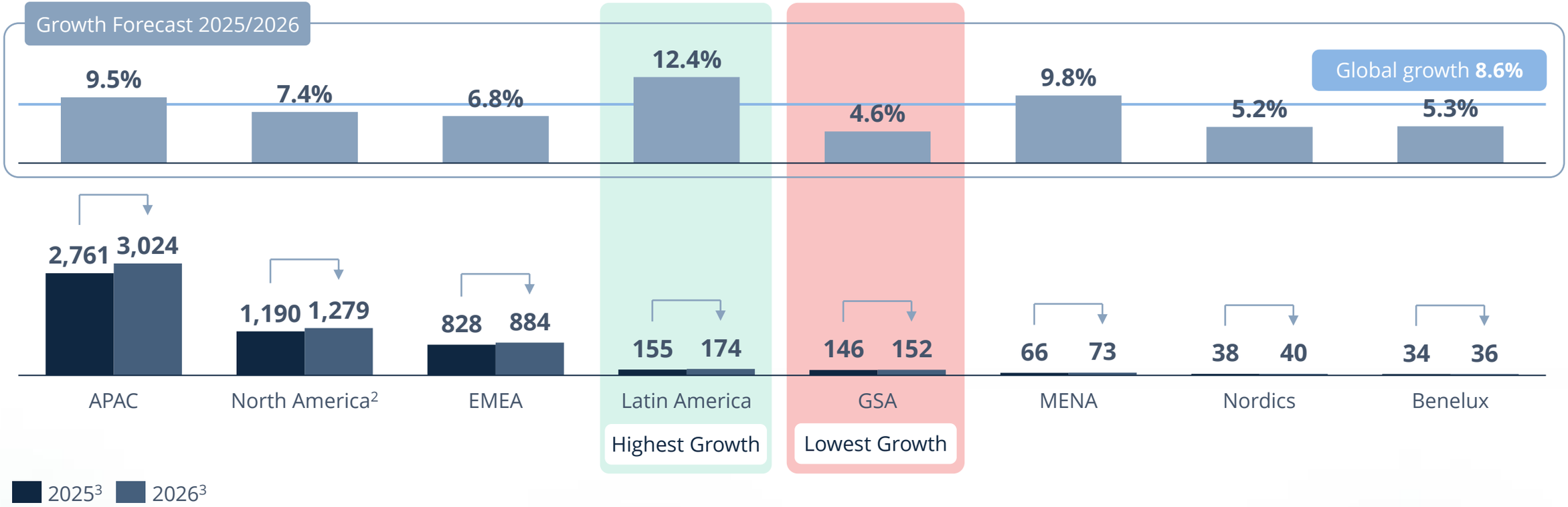
Latin America Records Strong 12.4% Growth in 2026, While Europe – Especially GSA – Remains Far Below the Global Average of 8.6%

eCommerce Revenue Development by Geographical Regions[1], in Billion US$



Notes: (1) This analysis is based on geographic regions. ECDB also provides data on continents, political groupings (e.g., BRICS, EU), and individual countries (2) Includes the United States & Canada (3) Forecast

Source: ECDB, as of October 2025

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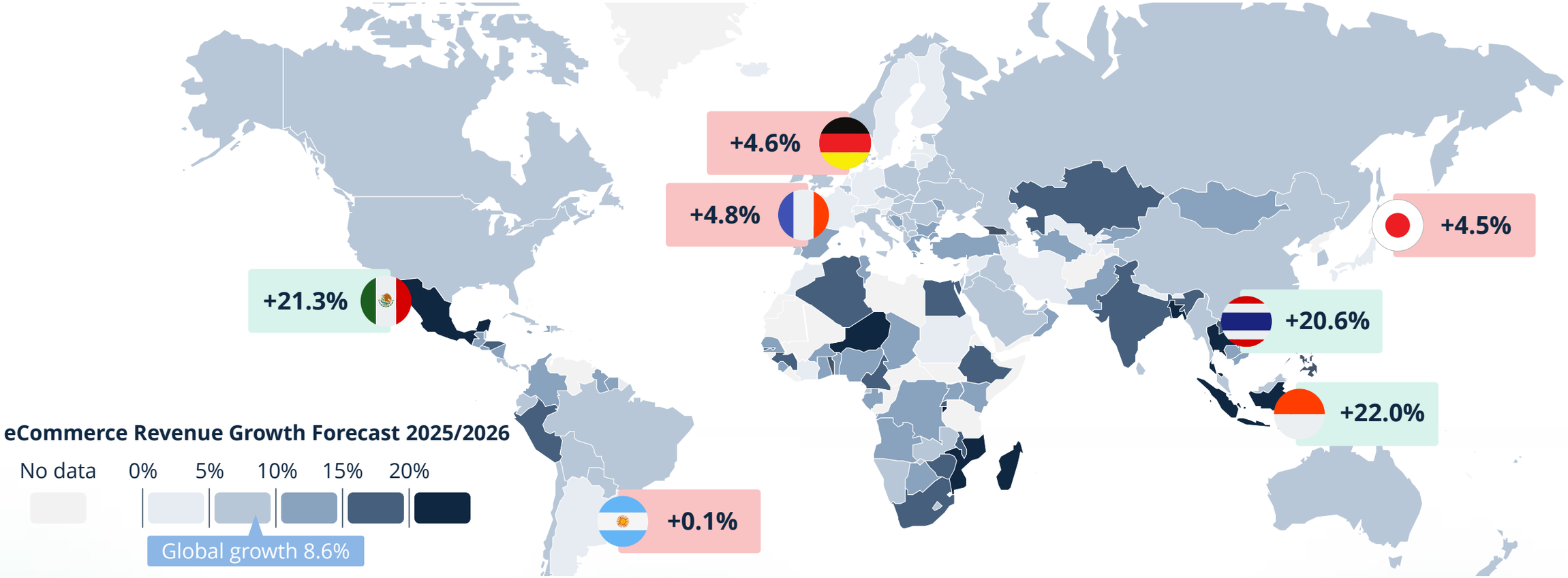
Thailand, Indonesia and Mexico Emerge as Key Potential Markets in 2026, While Western Europe Struggles With Sub-5% Growth



Source: ECDB, as of October 2025

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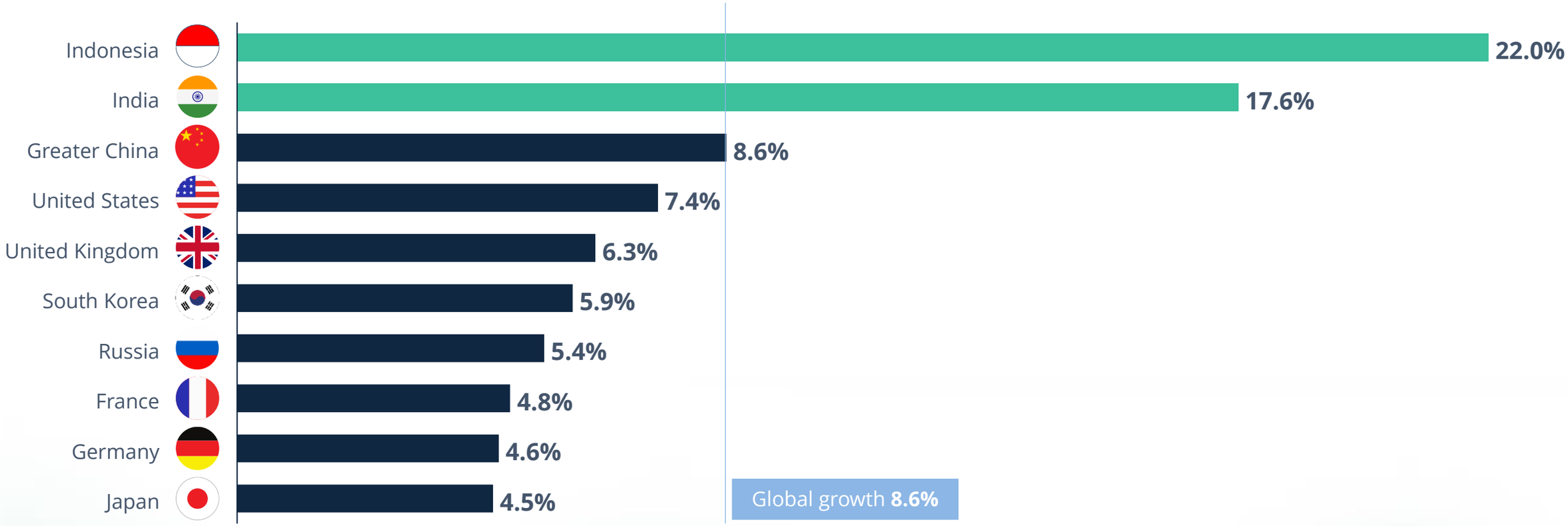
Top 10 eCommerce Nations: India (17.6%) and Indonesia (22.0%) Lead Growth, While Germany, France and Japan Struggle

Top 10 Countries by eCommerce Revenue in 2025 Ranked by 2025/2026 Growth Forecast



Source: ECDB, as of October 2025

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Retailers

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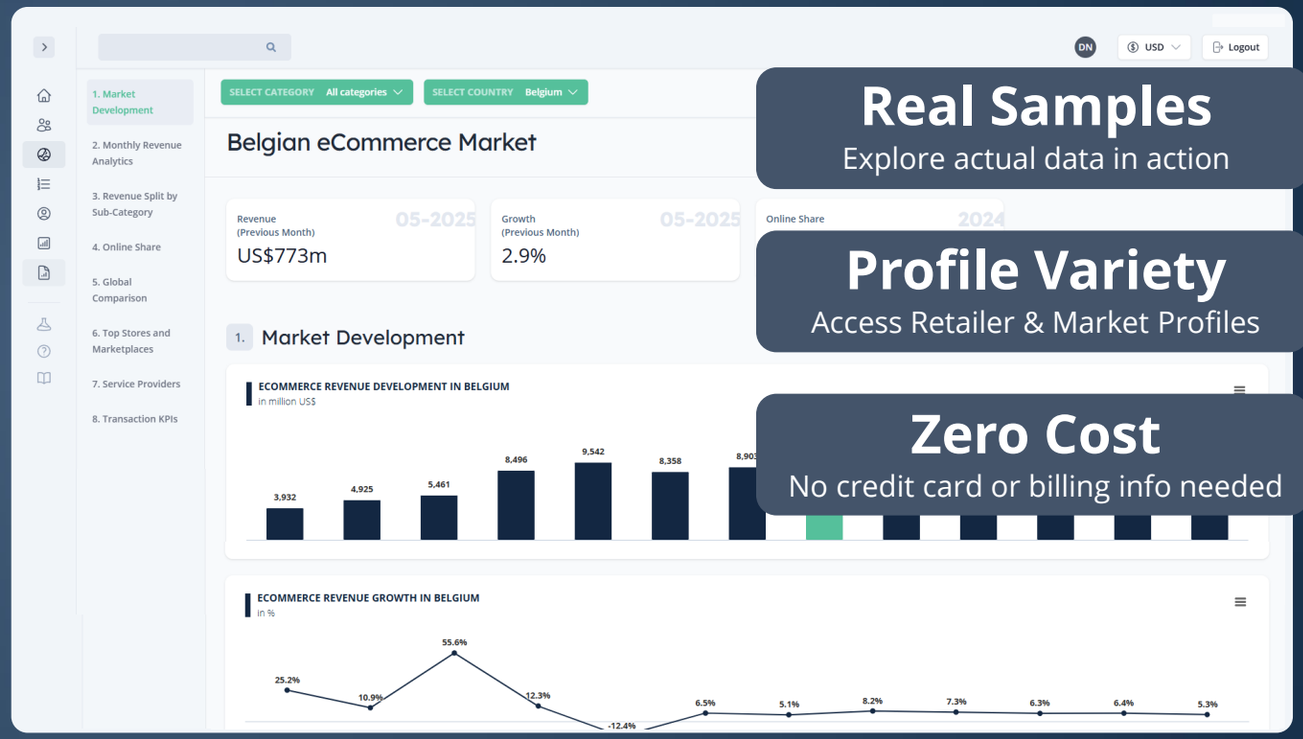
Markets

Belgium | Furniture



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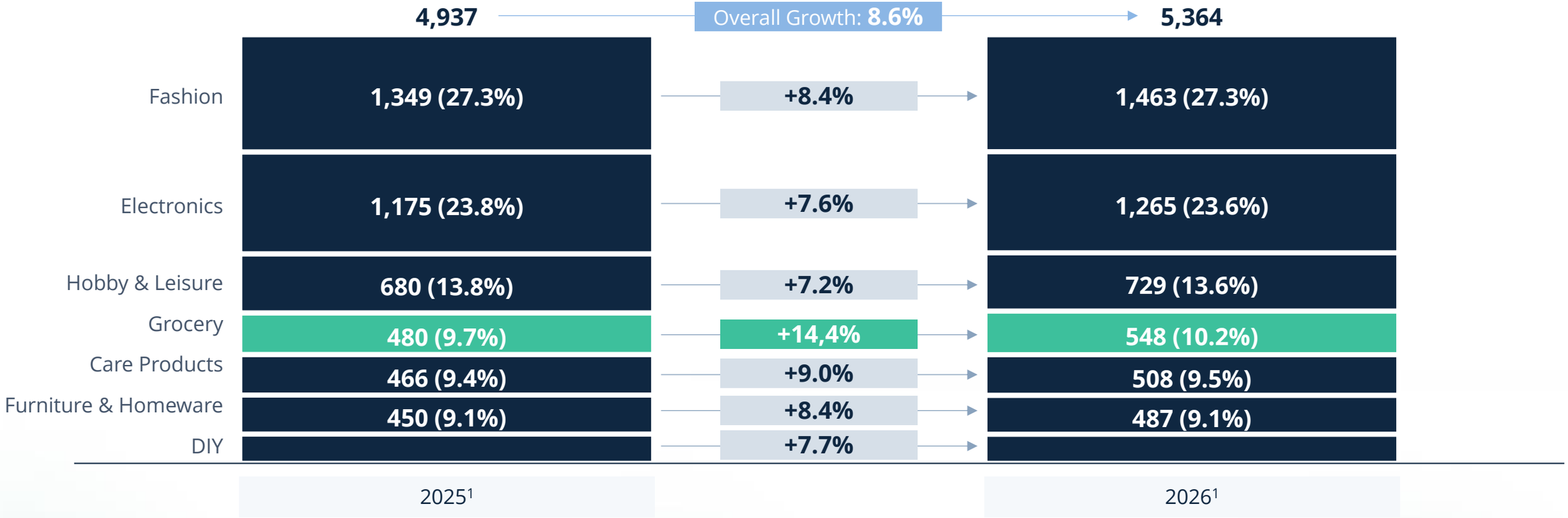
Grocery Emerges as 2026 Winner With 14.4% Growth, Surpassing 10% Revenue Share for the First Time in 2026

Market Size and Breakdown by Main Categories in US$ Billion



Notes: (1) Forecast

Source: ECDB, as of October 2025

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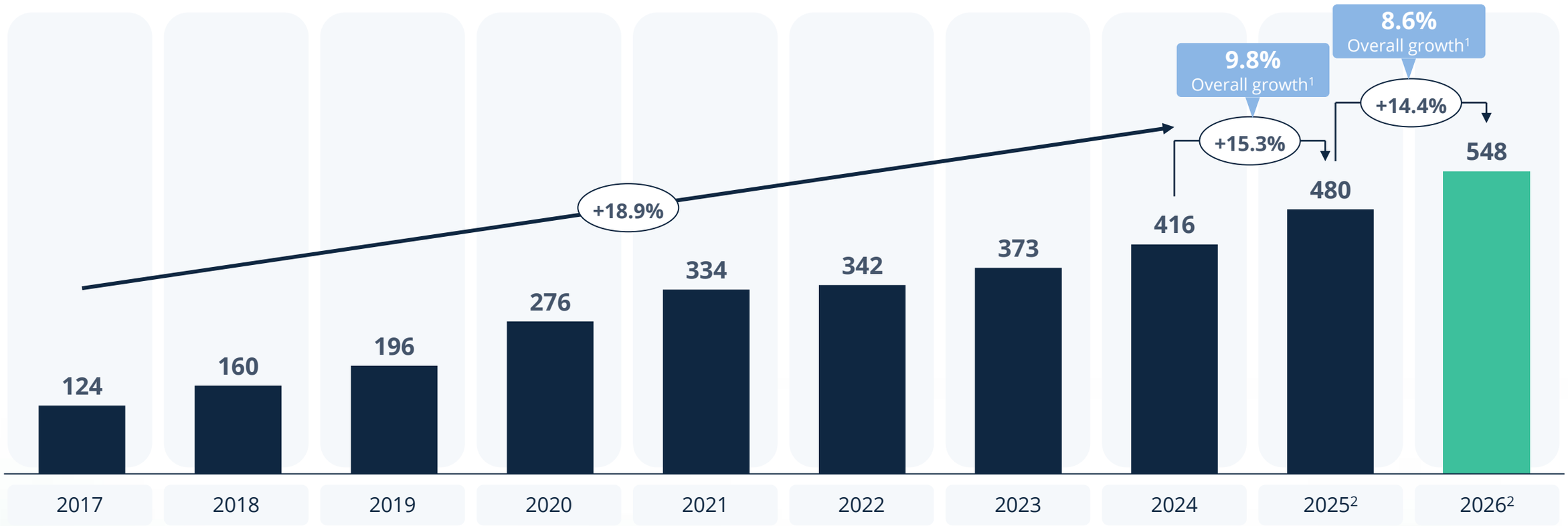
Even With a Mild Cooldown in 2026, Grocery Continues to Outpace the Market by More Than 5 Percentage Points

eCommerce Revenue Development in the Global Grocery eCommerce Market, in Billion US$



Notes: (1) Total market growth across all countries and categories (2) Forecast

Source: ECDB, as of October 2025

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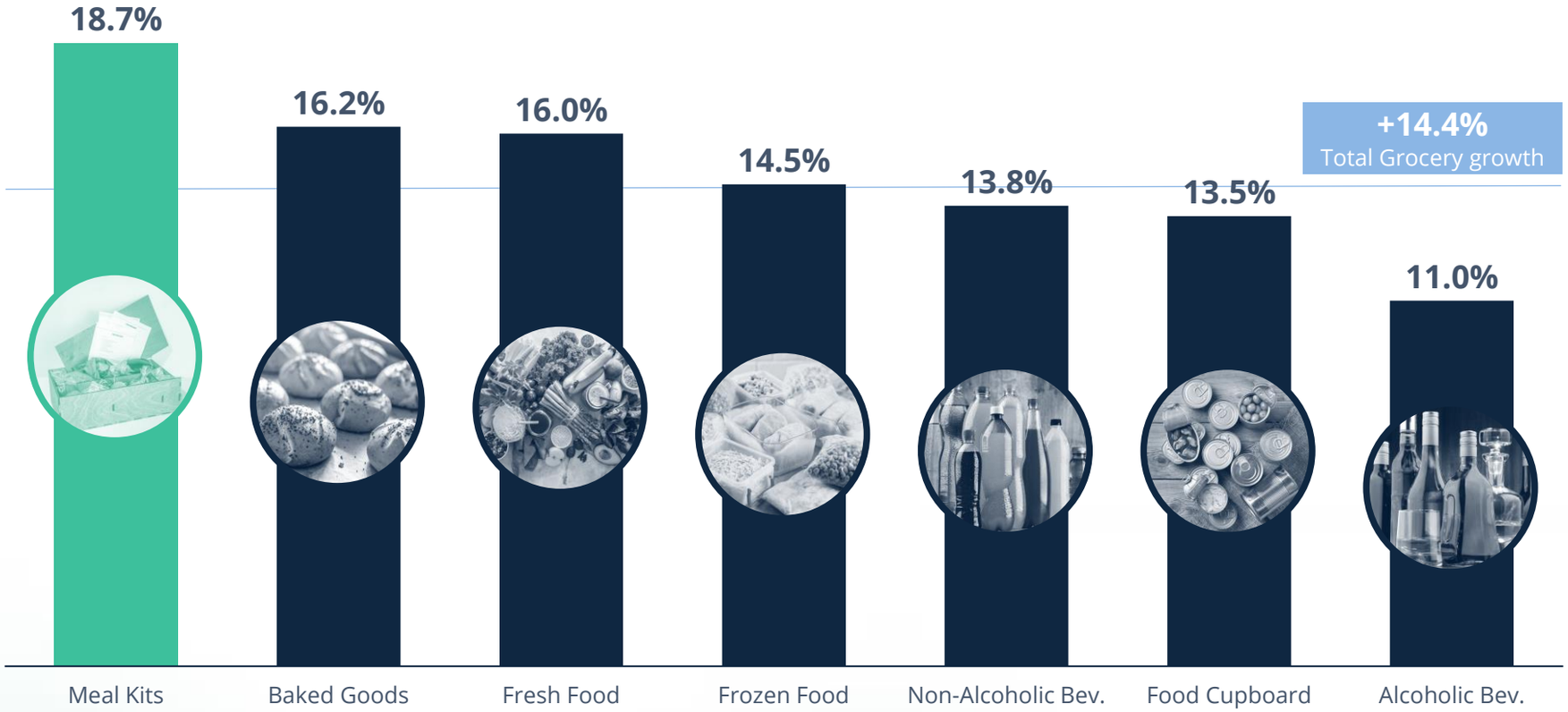
Meal Kits Drive Grocery Growth with Nearly 20% Surge by 2026 – Alcohol Expands Too, Yet Trails as Grocery's Weakest Performer

eCommerce Revenue Growth 2025/2026 by Subcategory in the Main Category Grocery



Meal Kits are the fastest-growing grocery category, with projected growth of **+18.7% by 2026**.

Their momentum reflects the strong consumer shift toward convenience and ready-to-cook solutions. Alcohol also expands above the sector average but still shows the weakest performance within grocery.

In addition, categories such as **Cleaning Equipment (+21.4%)** and **Pharmaceuticals (+19.2%)** are expected to show strong potential by 2026, underlining growth opportunities beyond the grocery segment.

Source: ECDB, as of October 2025

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- **Profile Variety**
  Access both detailed Retailer and Market Profiles.
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  Explore the platform freely, with no commitment required.
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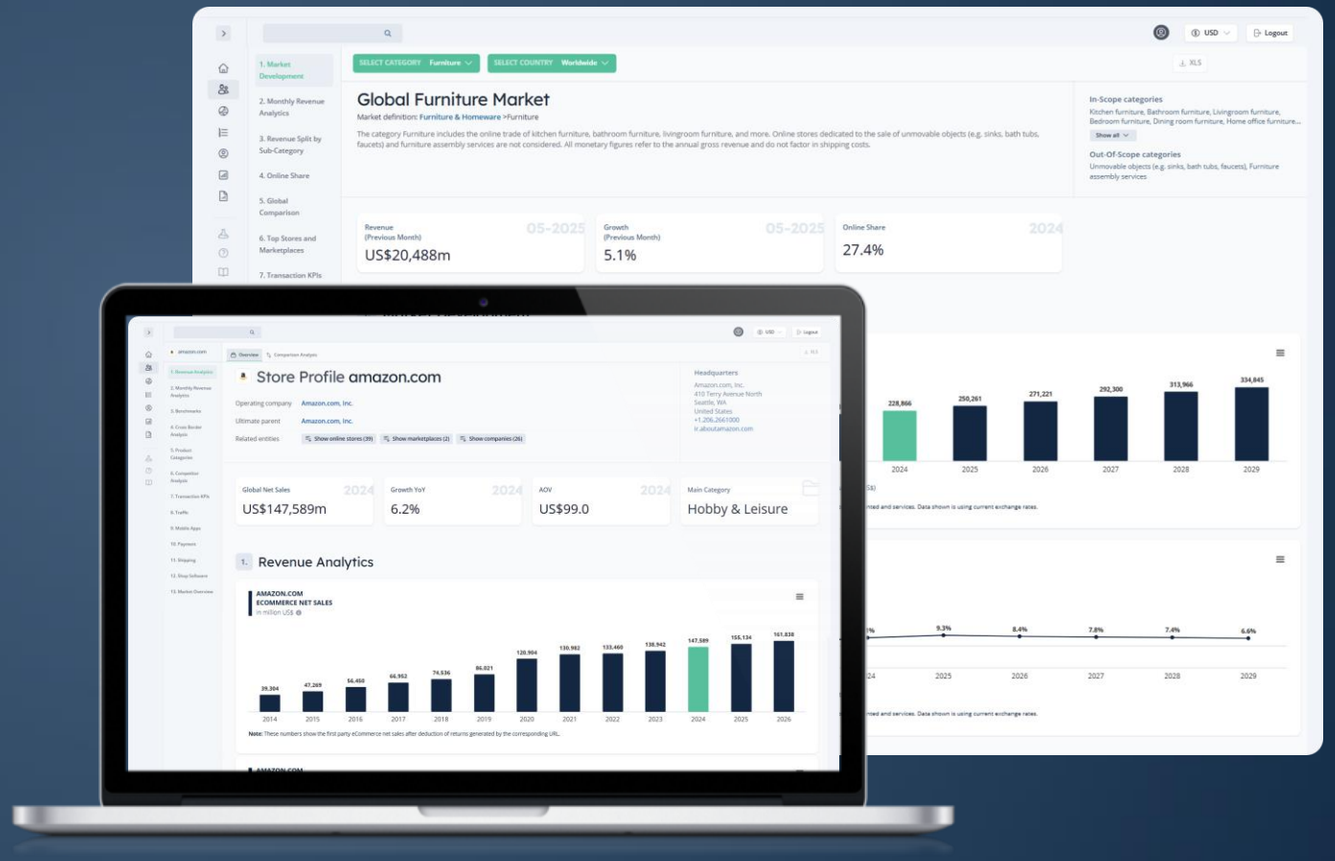

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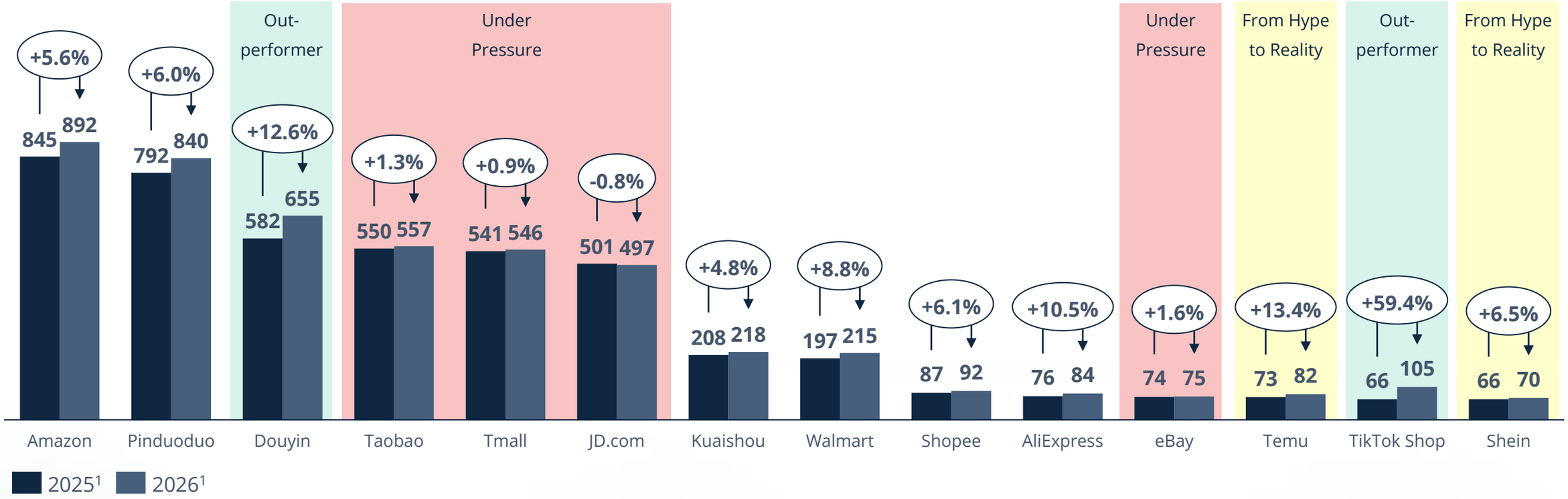
Douyin/TikTok Shop the Outperformer in 2026 – Established Giants Struggle and Former Disruptors Shein & Temu Arrive in a New Reality

Top 10 Retailers Worldwide by GMV in 2025, in Billions of US$



Notes: (1) Forecast

Source: ECDB, as of October 2025

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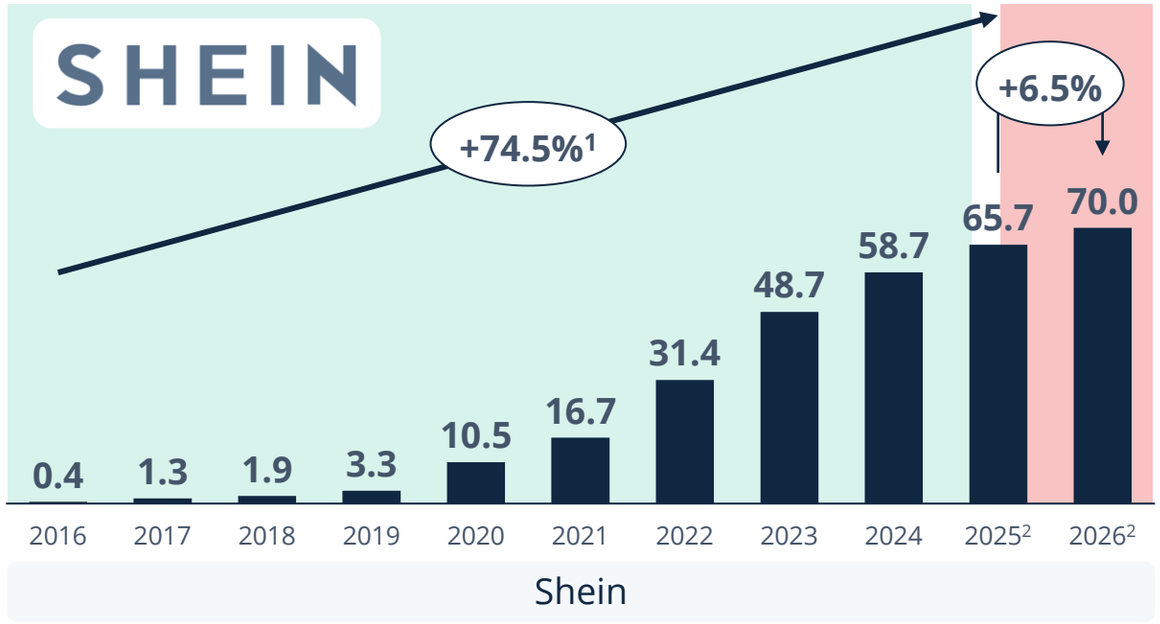
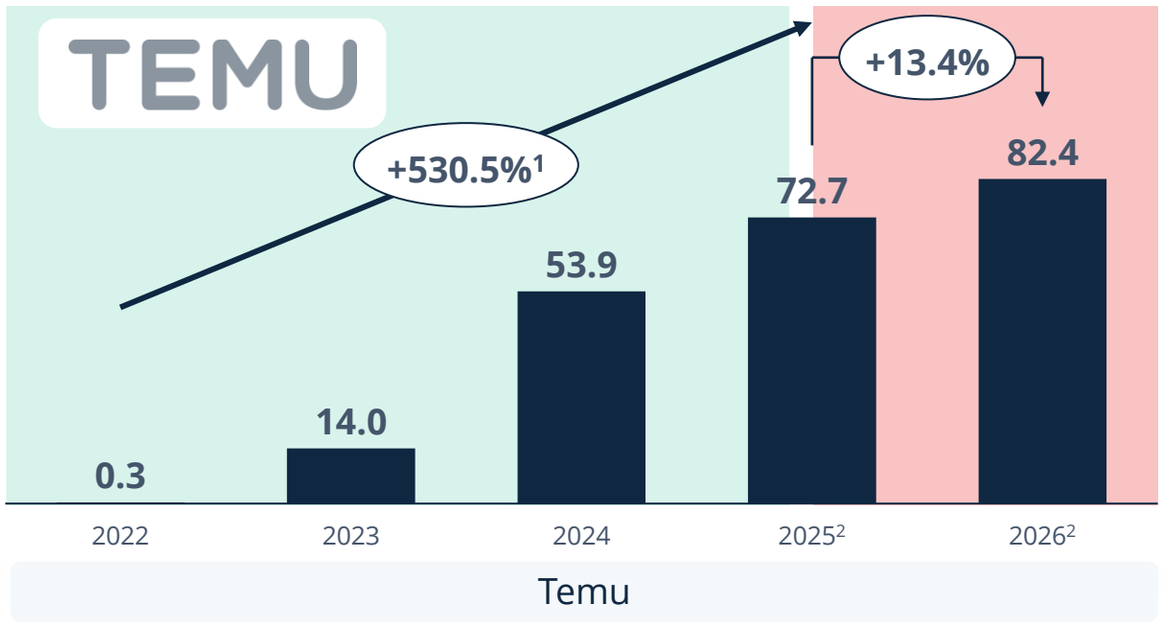
Shein & Temu: From Hypergrowth to Reality Check – 2026 Growth Slows to 6.5% and 13.4% as Tariffs Rise and De-Minimis Ends

Shein GMV Development, in Trillion US$



Temu GMV Development, in Trillion US$



After years of extraordinary expansion, Shein and Temu are entering a new phase. Shein's average annual growth of **74.5%** over the past nine years slows to just **6.5%** in 2026. Temu, which has surged with an average annual rate of **530%** since its launch, is projected to grow only **13.4%**. With tariffs on the horizon and the end of the de-minimis rule, the difficult macroeconomic environment leaves both players facing a reality check.

Notes: (1) Compound annual growth rate (2) Forecast

Source: ECDB, as of October 2025

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From Hype to Churn: US Retailers Capitalize on Shein & Temu's Slowdown – Especially Those Offering Value and Brand

The Disruptors: Profiting US Retailers

Brand Name	Lapsed Temu / Shein Shoppers	Overall	Difference
AÉROPOSTALE	101%	4%	97%
LOFT	43%	11%	32%
bloomingdale's	52%	-4%	55%
carter's	75%	15%	60%
DHgate.com	42%	26%	16%
FABLETICS	114%	35%	79%
KOHL'S	6%	-5%	11%
Nordstrom Rack	21%	12%	9%
nuuly	59%	34%	25%
OLD NAVY	12%	8%	4%
savers	45%	7%	37%
SPOILED CHILD	378%	125%	254%
ULTA BEAUTY	8%	4%	4%

As **shoppers churn from** fast-fashion giants like **Shein** and **Temu**, **value** and **mid-tier retailers** are **capturing demand –** with select premium brands also gaining share – **signaling** both **price sensitivity** and **early signs** of **up-trading behavior**.

Source: ECDB, as of October 2025; Consumer Edge

Five Core Theses Defining Global eCommerce in 2026

1. **eCommerce crosses the US$5 trillion mark** and enters a phase of stable, sustainable growth.
2. **Marketplaces** dominate globally, accounting for nearly **nine out of ten online sales dollars**
3. **Asia and Latin America set the global pace**, while Europe continues to lag behind.
4. **Grocery emerges as the standout growth engine**, powered by meal kits.
5. **Shein and Temu shift from hypergrowth to slowdown** as tariffs rise and de-minimis ends.

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